

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 5 4
 ♥ A 8 4 2
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ 10 7

♠ K 8 6 2

♥ 7 5

♦ A K 7

♣ A K 6 3



♠ J 7 3

♥ K J 9

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ 8 5 2

♠ A 9

♥ Q 10 6 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ Q J 9 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
 with West following suit.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 8

Don't worry any more about the ♦s since there is nothing more you can do. Instead, worry about where that one more winner is going to come from. The answer will have to be: *from the ♥ suit*.

You might be tempted to take your 4 ♣ tricks right away, but avoid the temptation. The ♣ suit is your convenient transportation back and forth between hands.

You will have to lose at least 2 ♥ tricks in order to set up 1 winner, and by the time you do that the defenders will have established at least 1 more ♦ trick. What that means is that you cannot afford 3 ♥ losers. So how will you play the ♥s?

You should play East for the ♥J plus one of the big ones. This is a better chance than playing him for both the ♥ A K. So play a ♥ toward dummy and insert the ♥10 when East plays low. West wins with the ♥A and clears the ♦s. Play another ♥ toward dummy's ♥Q. East can take his ♥K and cash his ♦ winner but dummy's ♥Q will be your ninth trick.

There were two ♥ distributions which would allow you to make this contract.

East could hold both the ♥A and ♥K, in which case leading toward dummy's ♥Q would be the winning play.

East could hold **EITHER** ♥ A J x **OR** ♥ K J x in which case finessing dummy's ♥J would be the winning play. This is the more likely distribution of the two.

With 9 points you have just enough to respond. And with a 4-card Major suit you should use Stayman so you bid 2♣. Partner duly replies 2♠.

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You don't have a 4-4 ♥ fit, so you invite the notrump game by bidding 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by South.

North plays 3NT and East leads the ♦Q. Should you win or hold up?

A pretty good argument against holding up could be that they might switch to ♠s. However, say you do in fact hold up and that East does in fact continue ♦s

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 7 3

♥ A 6

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ A Q 6 2

♠ K Q J 10

♥ K J 9 7 5 4

♦ A

♣ 9 5



♠ A 9 5

♥ Q 10 2

♦ K Q 10 6 3

♣ K 8

♠ 6 4 2

♥ 8 3

♦ 9 7 4

♣ J 10 7 4 3

You should not make a takeout double with three cards in their suit. A 2♦ overcall would be a reasonable choice. But with 15 points, balanced, and a stopper in ♥s a 1NT overcall is probably better.

Partner bids 3NT.

East plays 3NT. As expected, South leads his partner's ♥ suit.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1/2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 5/6

West

North

East

South

1♥

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

but you would then establish ♦s and make an overtrick!

You need at least 4 ♦ winners.

If you play low from dummy on the ♥ lead North can win the ♥K but this will give you an extra ♥ stopper. He could drive out dummy's ♥A at trick 2,

But who said North would play another ♥ after winning the ♥K? What if he wins the ♥K and switches to ♠s? They might then win 3 ♠ tricks to go with their ♥K and ♦A.

Instead you should grab the first trick with dummy's ♥A and start playing ♦s. North will take the ♦A but you still have the ♠A and ♥Q as stoppers.

Just look at North's hand. If you duck the ♥A it will be crystal clear to him that he can defeat the contract by winning the ♥K and then switching to the ♠K.

Don't give him the chance.